ArchiLudo

A Ludo game for Acorn Archimedes

Contents

Documentation

See `docs/` for the full project documentation: `ARCHITECTURE.md`, `BUILDCHAIN.md`, `GAME_LOGIC.md`, `BOARD_LAYOUT.md`, `OSLIB.md`, `LIBARCHIE.md`, `GRAPHICS_TOOLING.md`; plus `riscos_wimp_reference.md` for the WIMP/SWI/ message API reference, and `CREDITS.md` for everything this project is built on or derived from.

Building from source

Prerequisites

Tool	Purpose	Install
ArchieSDK	ARM2-targeting cross-compiler (GCC 8.5.0), bundled OSLib	`git clone https://gitlab.com/_targz/archiesdk.git ~/riscos-dev/archiesdk && cd ~/riscos-dev/archiesdk && ./build.sh`
Arculator	Acorn Archimedes emulator, for testing	already installed at `D:\Retro\Acorn\Arculator_V2.2_Windows`
pandoc	optional: README.md -> README.pdf	`sudo apt install pandoc texlive-xetex`
Python 3 + Pillow	`tools/riscos_sprite.py`, the PNG->Sprite converter	`pip install Pillow`

.env setup

Copy `.env.example` to `.env` and set:

```
ARCHIESDK = /home/xahmol/riscos-dev/archiesdk
ARCULATOR_HOSTFS = /mnt/d/Retro/Acorn/Arculator_V2.2_Windows/hostfs
```

`.env` is gitignored — never commit it.

Make targets

Target	Effect
`make` / `make all`	build the `build/!ArchiLudo` application directory
`make test`	build and run the game-logic unit tests with the host compiler (no ArchieSDK/Arculator needed)
`make clean`	remove `build/`
`make deploy`	copy `build/!ArchiLudo` to the Arculator hostfs folder
`make zip`	versioned release archive (`build/ArchiLudo-vX.Y.Z-<timestamp>.zip`), RISC OS filetypes preserved
`make disk`	ADFS "D" format (800KB) disc image containing the release zip, correctly filetyped
`make assets`	regenerate the pawn sprites and app icon from their Python generators
`make docs`	regenerate `README.pdf` via pandoc
`make asm`	emit generated ARM assembly for the current sources

`make zip`/`make disk` deliberately keep the full version+timestamp in their filenames (e.g. `ArchiLudo-v0.1.0-20260830-1503.zip`) so multiple builds can be told apart in `build/`. **Before copying either onto real classic-Econet hardware (a real PiEconetBridge, or any other old-style Level 3/4 fileserver), rename it to 10 characters or fewer with no dot** – e.g. `ArchiZip` for the zip, `ArchiADF` for the disc image. Longer names are silently truncated by such fileservers in a way that makes the file unreadable, not just renamed (see `docs/ARCHITECTURE.md`'s round 7.88 for the underlying cause). Arculator's hostfs and a plain download/extract on Windows/Mac/Linux have no such limit – this only matters for genuine old-style Econet-served hardware.

Testing: boot `configs/ArchiLudo-ARM3-4MB.cfg` (matches real ARM3/4MB hardware) or `configs/ArchiLudo-ARM2-1MB.cfg` (stock ARM2/1MB compatibility check) in Arculator with the RISC OS 3.10 ROM, then double-click `!ArchiLudo` from HostFS via the Filer (see `docs/BUILDCHAIN.md`'s "Application directory" section for its structure).

Status: Phase 1 (see `docs/ARCHITECTURE.md`'s Roadmap) – a playable core loop, extensively live-tested and refined in Arculator across many rounds of feedback (see `docs/ARCHITECTURE.md`'s round history).